Ethics Of AI

Macy Willis

Professor Michael J. O'Neill

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As a computer science major, the career that I would like to look further into pursuing is web development and graphic design. Entering a field like this is rapidly being transformed by Artificial Intelligence (AI). AI refers to systems capable of performing tasks that normally require human intelligence, like learning, reasoning, and problem-solving (Encyclopedia Britannica, 2024). Web developers are responsible for building and managing apps, while graphic designers create visuals for branding, marketing, and online communication and content. More than usual, both of these professional roles require pretty strong coding skills, unique creativity, and hands-on technical expertise. However, AI tools now generate code, design layouts, create logos, create marketing graphics, and even personalize the user experience.

As AI technology advances quickly, it raises many ethical questions about creation, authorship, employment, bias, and responsibility. In web design, AI can automatically generate website code when prompted, debug and optimize programs, personalize the user experience, create chatbots for customer service, and analyze user behavior for marketing purposes. In graphic design, AI can generate logos and branding concepts, create social media graphics instantly, remove background and enhance images, and automate repetitive design tasks. While these tools increase efficiency and productivity, they create multiple ethical challenges in their own ways. As future professionals, we must carefully examine how to ethically integrate AI into our work. Ethical concerns are in both fields, including job displacement, intellectual property violations, algorithmic bias, and accountability. Crawford (2021) argues that AI systems often reflect social inequalities embedded in training data. Kind of like O’Neil (2016) warns that algorithmic systems can amplify discrimination at scale.

The challenges we face now from AI in job displacement are that AI can reduce the demand for entry-level developers and designers. Automation could replace certain creative or technical roles. AI systems are also trained on large datasets that often include copyrighted artwork and code. This may cause designers to unknowingly produce artwork derived from someone else's intellectual property, leading to intellectual property challenges from AI. Furthermore, AI can also attract biased and discriminatory responses. AI systems can reflect bias in their training data. In web development, biased algorithms could affect hiring tools, marketing algorithms, or user personalization systems. For graphic designers, relying too heavily on AI can lead to a rapid decline in originality and human creativity. Last but not least, accountability and responsibility are one of the biggest concerns when talking about AI, really in any career field. However, in web design, if an AI-generated website contains security vulnerabilities or harmful content, it may be problematic. Then who would be responsible, the developer, the company, or the AI provider? The consequences of these ethical issues include serious real-world outcomes, such as economic gaps, copyright lawsuits, damaged reputations, and discrimination built into digital systems. Over time, these consequences can lead to people losing trust between users and technology professionals. Without ethical leadership, AI could weaken both professionals' integrity and social trust.

Now, by further analyzing these ethical questions and concerns using Christian ethical principles and professional codes such as the Association for Computing Machinery, also known as ACM, and the Institute of Electrical and Electronics Engineering, also known as IEEE, we can propose responsible solutions. Christian ethics emphasize love, justice, stewardship, and human dignity. Micah 6:8 (New International Version) reads that believers should pursue justice, show mercy, and walk humbly before God. In Matthew 22:37-39, Jesus explains that, among the

commands, the most important is to love your neighbor as you love God. In Galatians 5 verse 22-23 highlights qualities like kindness, faithfulness, and self-control as qualities that reflect a person's character. Genesis 1:27 (NIV) teaches that people are made in the image of God, giving them natural worth and creative value. From a Christians perspective, AI should be used to support and benefit humanity rather than replace them. Since humans are created in God's image, human creativity and moral reasoning are uniquely valuable. Therefore, using AI to take advantage of workers or eliminate jobs without regard for anyone's well-being would go against the idea of loving one's neighbor as you do God. Also, allowing biased AI systems to discriminate unfairly would go against the principle of justice. Failing to take responsibility for harm caused by AI outcomes would show a lack of integrity and stewardship. Overall, Christian ethics would encourage developers and designers to use AI as a tool that enhances human creativity instead of replacing it, while continuing to be fair, honest, and compassionate.

The ACM Code of Ethics (2018) emphasizes contributing to society, avoiding harm, and respecting intellectual property. The IEEE Code of Ethics (2020) focuses mainly on the public welfare, honesty, and taking responsibility in technological development. By applying ACM code to AI in web development and graphic design, developers must ensure AI systems don't harm users, must respect copyright and intellectual property laws, must disclose AI usage when appropriate, and must work to reduce bias in automated systems. The ACM code isn't based on religion; instead, it focuses more on professional responsibility and public good. It strongly emphasizes accountability and fairness. The IEEE code of ethics stresses that one should hold paramount the safety, health, and welfare of the public, avoid conflicts of interest, be honest and realistic in claims, and improve understanding of technology and its consequences. In AI context, web developers must prioritize user safety and data protection; graphic designers must avoid

misleading AI-generated marketing; and professionals must understand and communicate AI's risks. The IEEE approach is similar to ACM but emphasizes engineering responsibility and public safety.

There are similarities between the Christian worldview and the ACM and IEEE codes. There are similarities between the Christian worldview and the ACM and IEEE codes of conduct. They all emphasize avoiding harm, supporting honesty and integrity, stressing responsibility toward society, and recognizing the importance of fairness. For example, the Christian teaching commands believers to love their neighbors (Matthew 22:39, NIV), including preventing harm through technology. Also, in Romans 14:12, NIV, it teaches us about personal moral responsibility before God. A developer cannot shift blame to "the algorithm"; responsibility ultimately rests with the human creator.

However, there are both differences and similarities. Christian ethics is rooted in obedience to God and His divine law and the belief that humans are created in His image. ACM and IEEE are secular and grounded in professional standards instead of spiritual authority. Christian ethics focuses more on a person's character, including their humility, mercy, and self-control (Galatians 5:22-23). On the other hand, professional codes emphasize following clear, specific rules and standards. Christian theology also stresses the importance of the value of human dignity and creative purposes. In creative fields such as graphic design, completely replacing human creativity just to increase profit might raise a bigger concern within the Christian framework than within a purely secular professional model. Are they compatible yet? The professional codes do align closely with the biblical principles of justice, honesty, and love of your neighbor. Christian ethics may provide a deeper motivation since it connects moral responsibility to accountability before God. Do they sufficiently address AI challenges?

Professional codes have guidelines, but they may not go as far into addressing deeper issues like human identity and creativity. The Christian point of view speaks more directly about human uniqueness and moral purpose behind our work.

In conclusion, AI will continue transforming web development and graphic design. Instead of resisting AI, professionals must integrate it ethically. I believe that AI can be used as a tool to help us rather than something that replaces human creativity. Developers and designers should be honest and disclose AI-generated content when appropriate, always check for bias and unfair outcomes, respect copyright laws, avoid unethical data use, and prioritize human well-being over efficiency or profit. I believe that putting those things first will enable ethical integration to be achieved more effectively. If possible, banning AI entirely across all creative professions would be an alternative. However, that is unrealistic and would slow down any progress made and innovation. Another alternative is allowing unrestricted AI use without ethical oversight. Yet this would likely increase harm, bias, and loss of accountability. I believe the best path forward is ethical leadership. Technology professionals need to combine their technical skills and a clear sense of moral responsibility. Whether motivated by their Christian faith or by professional codes like ACM and IEEE, the goal should be the same either way. Ensure that AI helps people instead of hurting them now and in the future. As future leaders in computer science, we are not only building technology but also shaping how it can and will affect the society we live in. AI is a powerful tool, but it also needs to be guided by ethical principles to ensure its use.

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